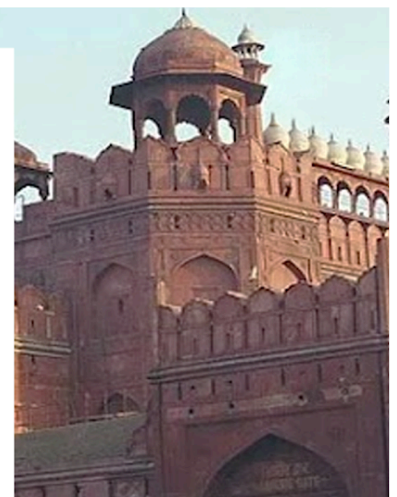
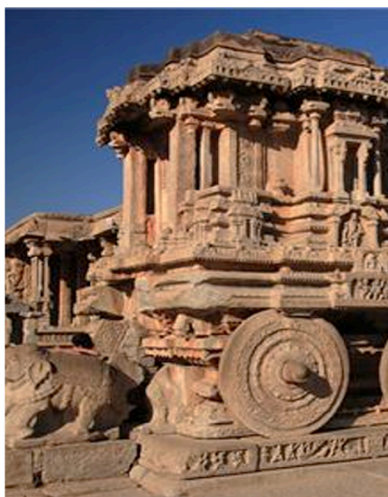


General Knowledge

Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

The Maratha Kingdom



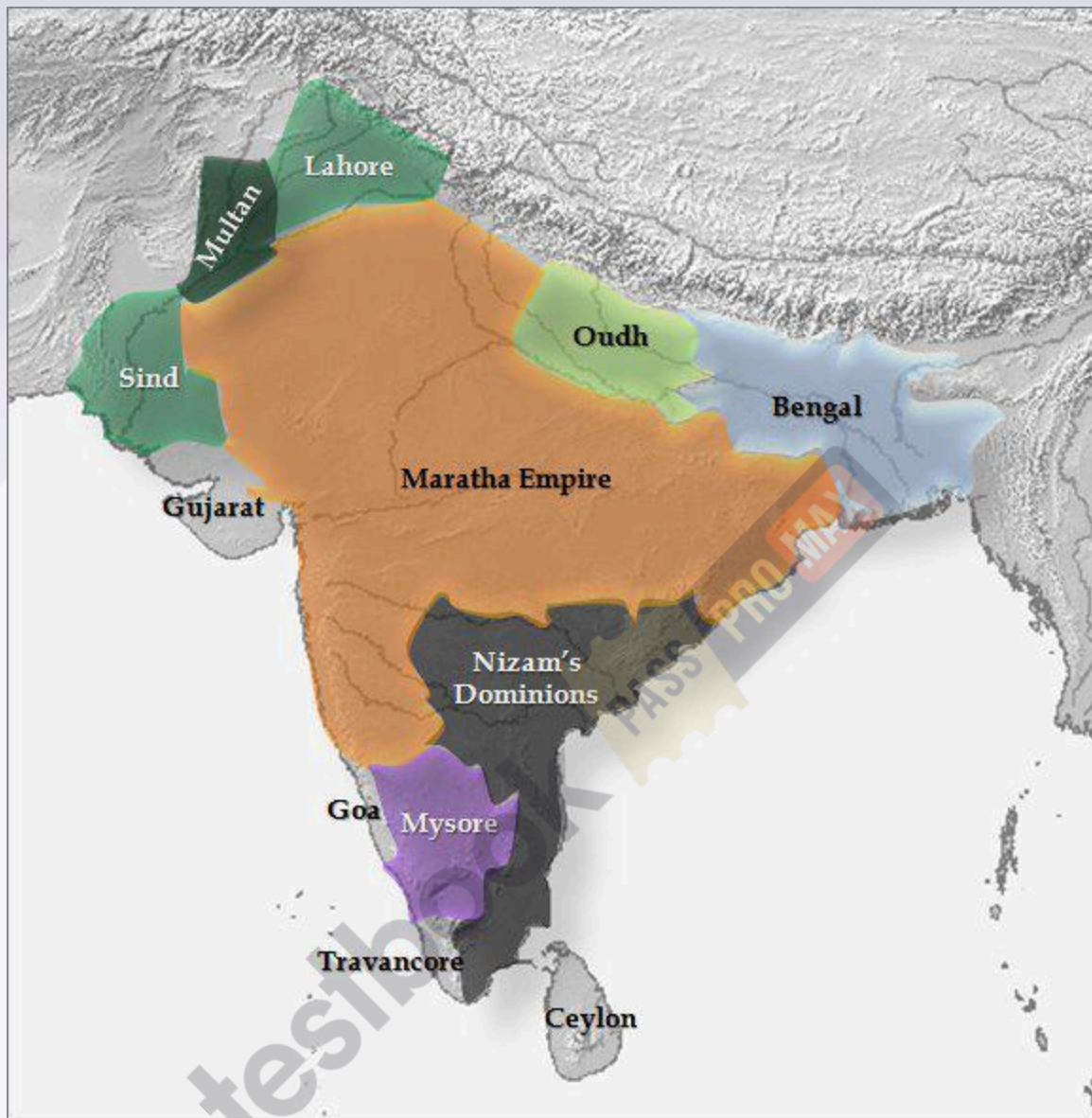
Maratha Kingdom

The Rise of Marathas

- The Maratha Empire was **also known as the Maratha Confederacy**.
- It was an early modern Indian confederation that came to dominate most of the Indian subcontinent in the 18th century.
- The **Maratha Empire was founded by Chhatrapati Shivaji, in the late 17th century** as a reaction to the anarchy and misgovernment that characterised the Deccans at the time.
- This happened at the same time the Mughal Empire grew into southern India.
- Hindu nationalists hold the Maratha Empire in high regard since it was founded by a warrior Hindu population on the western Deccan peninsula.
- They respect this state because it reversed centuries of progressively expanding Muslim political dominance throughout the subcontinent.
- **It was the biggest state in South Asia by the middle of the 18th century**, and the Delhi-based Mughal rulers served as its slaves.

History

- The **origin of the Maratha Empire started with a well-known fighter, Chhatrapati Shivaji**, who founded the Maratha Empire.
- He developed a group of Marathi warriors who lived on the western Deccan Plateau for a long time.
- In 1645, Shivaji led a group known as the Marathas in a revolt against the Sultanate of Bijapur.
- The term **"Hindavi Swarajya,"** which demanded self-rule among the Hindus, was later coined by Shivaji.



- One of the main causes of the hatred for the Mughals was Shivaji's clashes with them, which began in 1657.
- In the meantime, Shivaji acquired substantial amounts of land through his conquests.
- Shivaji created an army to confront the Mughal-Maratha wars.
- Shivaji became a proclaimed king of the Maratha kingdom on June 6, 1674, intending to establish a Hindu state in the subcontinent.
- Shivaji's coronation was conducted in such a way that it served as a warning to all the non-Hindu kings.
- In the Maratha Empire timeline, the last Maratha king was Shahaji (Satara Chhatrapati) Shahaji II

- **There are two parts of the Maratha Empire:**
 - Shiv Shahi
 - Peshwa
- Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj established the 'Swaraj' in the first half of the seventeenth century.
- The decline of the Mughal Empire was the rise of the Marathas under the Peshwa.
- They consolidated their position in Western India and then started entertaining plans for a Hindu Pad Padshahi.
- The Marathas became the strongest power in Northern India in the mid-18th century.
- They played the role of king-makers at the Delhi court.
- They acted as the defenders of the country against foreign invaders like Ahmad Shah Abdali.

Shahajiraje

- Shahajiraje was the father of Shivaji Maharaj.
- He was a preeminent Sardar in the Deccan.
- Shahaji Maharaj did not wish the Mughals to get an entry into the South. So he tried to save Nizamshahi by offering stiff resistance to the Mughals. But he could not withstand the combined might of the Mughals and the Adilshah.
- He had won many regions in Maharashtra, Karnataka, and Tamil Nadu.
- While Shivaji and Jijabai were in Bengaluru, he had arranged to provide Shivaji with an excellent education to enable him to become a king.
- After the Nizamshahi was wiped out, Shahajiraje became a *Sardar* of the Adilshah of Bijapur.

Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj

testbook

Born: 19 Feb. 1630
Died: 3 Apr. 1680

CHHATRAPATI SHIVAJI MAHARAJ

- ★ He was born in the hill fort of **Shivneri**, near the city of Junnar in Pune district of Maharashtra on 19 Feb 1630.
- ★ He was crowned as **Chhatrapati of Raigad** on June 6th, 1674.
- ★ From a small contingent of over 2000 soldiers inherited from his father, he created a force of **1,00,000 soldiers**.
- ★ He Pioneered Guerrilla Warfare methods, referred to as **Shiva Sutra**.
- ★ He promoted use of **Marathi & Sanskrit**, rather than Persian in Administration.

"Shivaji Maharaj Rajmudra" is the official stamp of Shivaji Maharaj which was used on his official letters, orders etc.

Afzal Khan, a veteran general was killed at a truce negotiation meeting with Shivaji & his army was defeated at the Battle of **Pratapgad**.



Birth and Early Life:

- Born on February 19, 1630, at Shivneri Fort in Pune, Maharashtra.
- Parents: Shahaji Bhosle and Jijabai.
- Influenced by his mother Jijabai and guardian Dadoji Kondadeo.
- Jijabai instilled in him a strong cultural and religious identity.
- Dadoji Kondadeo trained him in administration, military strategy, and revenue systems.

- Grandfather Maloji served as a general in the Ahmadnagar Sultanate and was given the title "Raja."
- Maloji was granted Deshmukh rights for Pune, Supe, Chakan, and Indapur and received Shivneri Fort as a family residence.

Formation of the Maratha Kingdom:

- Broke away from the Sultanate of Bijapur and established an independent rule, marking the start of the Maratha Confederacy.
- Established a strong government with a well-organized administration and disciplined army.
- Formally crowned as Chhatrapati in 1674 at Raigad Fort.
- Recognized as the "Father of the Indian Navy" for his efforts in fortifying the Konkan coastline.
- Pioneered guerrilla warfare tactics, earning the nickname "Mountain Rat."
- Promoted inclusivity by recruiting individuals from various castes, religions, including Muslims and Europeans, into his administration and military.

Wars and Conquests:

- **Conflicts with the Bijapur Sultanate:**
 - Began his military campaign in 1645.
 - Captured Torna Fort in 1646 at the age of 16.
 - Expanded by taking forts such as Purandar, Kondhana, and Chakan.
 - Established headquarters at Rajgad.
 - Bijapur imprisoned his father, Shahaji, in 1648, releasing him in 1649.
 - Continued expansion by defeating rivals like Chandra Rao More.
 - Strengthened power through military strategies, alliances, and diplomatic negotiations.
 - Bijapur sent Afzal Khan to subdue him in 1657.
- **Battle of Pratapggarh (1659):**
 - Fought between Shivaji's army and Bijapur forces led by Afzal Khan.
 - Marathas secured a decisive victory.
- **Capture of Panhala Fort (1659-1660):**
 - After defeating Bijapur forces, advanced towards the Konkan region.

- Captured Panhala Fort but had to surrender it to Bijapur general Siddi Jauhar in 1660.
- Later recaptured Panhala in 1673.
- **Battle of Pavan Khind (1660):**
 - Marathas resisted Bijapur forces led by Siddi Masud but suffered defeat.
 - The battle site was later renamed Paavan Khind.
- **Conflict with the Mughal Empire:**
 - Initially allied with the Mughals but later rebelled.
 - Raided Mughal territories in 1657.
 - Aurangzeb sent Nasiri Khan to suppress him, but the campaign was ineffective.
- **Battle of Chakan (1660):**
 - Marathas fought against Mughal forces led by Shaista Khan.
 - Marathas lost, and Chakan was captured by the Mughals.
- **Attack on Surat (1664):**
 - Raided the wealthy Mughal trading city of Surat.
- **Treaty of Purandar (1665):**
 - Signed with Aurangzeb's general, Jai Singh.
 - Shivaji agreed to recognize Mughal authority.
 - Sent his son, Sambhaji, to serve in the Mughal court.
- **Detention in Agra and Escape (1666):**
 - Summoned to Aurangzeb's court and placed under house arrest.
 - Escaped with his son Sambhaji on August 17, 1666.
- **Peace with Mughals (1666-1668):**
 - Mediated by Jaswant Singh.
 - Aurangzeb gave him the title of "Raja" and reinstated Sambhaji as a Mughal mansabdar.
- **Battle of Sinhagad (1670):** Marathas, led by Tanaji Malusare, recaptured Sinhagad Fort from the Mughals.
- **Battle of Salher (1672):** First major victory of the Marathas against the Mughal Empire.
- **Southern India Campaigns (1674-1677):**
 - Captured Ponda, Karwar, and Kolhapur.
 - Formed alliances with Golconda's Qutubshah.
 - Advanced into Karnataka and Tamil Nadu.

Administration:

- **Ashta Pradhan:**
 - Council of eight ministers responsible for governance.
 - Ministers oversaw administration, finance, military, foreign affairs, and justice.
 - Panditrao and Nyayadhis handled religious and legal matters.
- **Language Policies:**
 - Promoted Marathi as an official language.
 - Replaced Persian and Arabic terms with Sanskrit equivalents.
 - Used Sanskrit in his royal seal.
- **Religious Policies:**
 - Advocated religious harmony.
 - Recruited Muslim commanders, including Darya Sarang.
 - Interacted with spiritual figures like Samarth Ramdas.

Military Strategy:

- Utilized guerrilla tactics to ambush and retreat into mountain forts.
- Maintained a highly mobile and efficient army.
- Strengthened hill forts such as Rajgad, Torna, and Sinhagad.
- Controlled around 240-280 forts by the time of his death.
- **Naval Strategy:**
 - Established a strong naval presence to protect the Konkan coast.
 - Built Sindhudurg Fort as the naval headquarters.
 - Recruited skilled seafarers, including Malabar pirates and Muslim mercenaries.

Successors:

- Two sons: Sambhaji and Rajaram.
- Sambhaji took the throne after his father's death in 1681.
- Sambhaji was captured and executed by the Mughals.
- Rajaram fled to Ginjee Fort and later ruled from Satara.

- Rajaram's son, Shivaji II (Ramaraja), succeeded him under the regency of Tara Bai.
- Shahu, son of Sambhaji, later became ruler and appointed Balaji Vishwanath as Peshwa in 1713, leading to the rise of the Peshwa era.

Maratha Empire during the Peshwa Era

Reign of Sambhaji

- After the death of Shivaji, the Maratha Empire flourished under the leadership of Shivaji's son Sambhaji.
- The Maratha soldiers under Sambhaji never lost a fight to the Aurangzeb-led Mughal forces for eight years despite the persistent threat from Aurangzeb.
- But in 1689, Sambhaji was apprehended and put to death by the Mughals on various charges, including rape and murder.
- The Maratha Empire was thereafter ruled by several different people, including Sambhaji's son Shahu, Rajaram, Tarabai, and Rajaram's widow.
- Balaji Vishwanath was chosen to serve as the Maratha Empire's Prime Minister (Peshwa) during Shahu's reign in 1713.
- Shahu's Prime Minister Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath used Shahu as a puppet as time went on, making important choices for the betterment of the empire



Some Notable Rulers of the Maratha Empire

Tanaji Malusare	• Tanaji Malusare was a military assistant of Maratha King Shivaji. • The Sinhagad fort is also known as the Kondhana fort. • The battle was fought between Tanaji Malusare, from the Shivaji side, and Uday Bhann Singh Rathore, from the Mughal emperor Aurangzeb's side.
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	The battle of Kondhana was fought on 04 Feb 1670 at the fort of Sinhagad.
Rajaram (1689-1700)	- Rajaram succeeded to the throne with the help of the ministers. - He was the youngest brother of Sambhaji, son of Shivaji, and his wife was Tarabai. - He escaped from Satara and took shelter at Gingee. But the continued war against the Mughals. - Aurangzeb captured Gingee Fort in 1698 but Rajaram escaped. - He added the post of Pratinidhi in Ashtapradhan. Therefore the total number of ministers becomes nine. - He died at Satara.
Balaji Vishwanath	- Balaji Vishwanath began his career as a revenue official. - The Senakarte (maker of the Army) title was given to him by Shahu in 1708. - He assisted the Syed Brothers in deposing Mughal Emperor Farrukhsiyar in 1719.
	He was the eldest son of Balaji Vishwanath and succeeded him as

Baji Rao I	Peshwa at the early age of 20. • He was acknowledged as the most influential of the nine Peshwas. • Marathas under Bajirao I raided the outskirts of Delhi in the Battle of Delhi in 1737. • Peshwa Baji Rao I captured Salsette and Bassein in the battle of 1739 against the Portuguese. • Due to the excellent war skills of Baji Rao I, the Marathas were able to defeat the Portuguese. • Baji Rao I Helped conquer Central India and Rajputana and extended his dominions into Gujarat in the northwest and Deccan in the south. • He raided Mughal Delhi in 1738. He was the most powerful Peshwa.
Balaji Bajirao	• He was popularly known as Nana Saheb. • He succeeded his father at the age of twenty. • Managed to extend the Maratha territories into most of North, West, East, and Central India. • Lost the Third Battle of Panipat in 1761.

Shahu	• The Mughal Emperor Bahadur Shah • released Shahuji, which led to the foundation of a civil war between him and Tarabai. • Shahu defeated Tarabai at the Battle of Khed (October 12, 1707) and occupied Satara. • During his reign, the Maratha kingdom was split into parts: Kolhapur under Tarabai and Satara under Shahu. • In 1731, the two feuds were finally settled through the 'Treaty of Warna.'
Tarabai	• After Rajaram, The Throne was succeeded by his minor son Shivaji-2 under the guardianship of his mother, Tarabai. • Tarabai ruled indirectly and her infant son Shivaji was the real emperor.

Maratha Empire: Wars and Conquests

- There were three Anglo-Maratha Wars between the British and the Marathas from 1775 to 1818.

First Anglo-Maratha War (1775–1782):	• The First Anglo-Maratha War was fought in 1775-1782 between the East India Company and the Marathas. • Favouring the cause of the Raghunath Rao (Raghoba) for Peshwaship, Hastings came into conflict with the Marathas. • The British were defeated in this battle and had to sign the humiliating Convention of Wadgaon (1779). • The British later signed the Treaty Of Salbai (1782)
Results • The British retained Salsette and Broach. • The Marathas agreed to not give any territory to the French. • All territories taken by the British after the Treaty of Purandhar were given back to the Marathas. • Madhavrao II (son of Narayanrao) was accepted as the Peshwa.	

**Second Anglo-Maratha War
(1803–1805):**

- The Second Anglo-Maratha War started in circumstances similar to those of the first.
- After Peshwa Madhavrao Narayan committed suicide in 1795, Bajirao II, the son of Raghunathrao, became the Peshwa.
- Nana Phadnavis, a bitter foe of Bajirao II, became the chief minister.
- The dissensions among the Marathas provided the English with an opportunity to intervene in Maratha affairs.
- The death of Nana Phadnavis in 1800 gave the British an added advantage.
- The war (1802-1805) ended with the Treaty of Rajghat.
- It was signed between the Holkars and the British in the year 1805.
- The Second Anglo-Maratha War happened due to the Maratha Confederacy's non-recognition of the Treaty of Bassein (1802), which made the Maratha accept the Subsidiary Alliance.
- A treaty between Bhonsle and the British was called the Treaty of Deogaon& signed in 1803.
- As a result of the war, large parts of central India came under British control.

Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817–1818):	• Lord Hastings had the imperialistic design of imposing British paramountcy. • By the Charter Act of 1813, the East India Company's monopoly of trade in China (except tea) ended and hence the company needed more markets. • The Pindaris made up of many castes and classes, were attached to Maratha armies as mercenaries. • When the Marathas became weak, the Pindaris could not get regular employment. As a consequence, they started plundering neighbouring territories, including those of the Company. • The English charged the Marathas by giving shelter to the Pindaris. • Pindari leaders like Amir Khan and Karim Khan surrendered while Chitu Khan fled into the jungles. • The Treaty of Gwalior was signed in 1817 between Shinde and the British, even though he had not been involved in the war. • The Treaty of Mandasor was signed between the British and the Holkar chief in 1818. • The Peshwa surrendered in 1818. • His adopted son, Nana Saheb, became one of the leaders of the Revolt of 1857 at Kanpur. • The territories annexed from the Pindaris became the Central Provinces under British India.
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	This war led to the end of the Maratha Empire. All the Maratha powers surrendered to the British.
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Causes for the downfall of the Maratha Empire:

- The Third Battle of Panipat caused an enormous loss of men and money for the Marathas.
- The other reason for the downfall of the Maratha Empire was its own structure.
- Its nature was that of a confederacy where power was shared among the chiefs or sardars (Bhonsle, Holkar, etc).
- They failed to develop an efficient system of revenue administration.
- New territories were conquered but much less focus was on the administration.
- Marathas did not take the trouble to find out what was happening elsewhere and what their enemies were doing.
- The Maratha system of administration was along the lines of their predecessors. There was no progressivism.

Some Important Terms during the Maratha Empire

Chauth and Sardeshmukhi	Chauth was one-fourth of the land revenue paid to the Marathas to avoid the Maratha raids. It was nominally levied at 25% on revenue or produce. Sardeshmukhi was an additional levy of 10 percent on those lands on which the Marathas claimed hereditary rights. - Marathas were granted the right to collect Chauth and Sardeshmukhi by the Mughals in exchange for a promise to not raid adjoining Mughal territories
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Sardar and Jahagir:

- **Jahagir or jagir means the right to enjoy the revenue of a region.**
- The Sardars in the service of rulers used to get the revenue of the region as income instead of getting salaries directly.